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From Imagined Color to Landscape Reality

Color is not applied.
It is produced.

A landscape that feels unreal.
Soft.
Saturated.
Impossible.

These colors already exist.

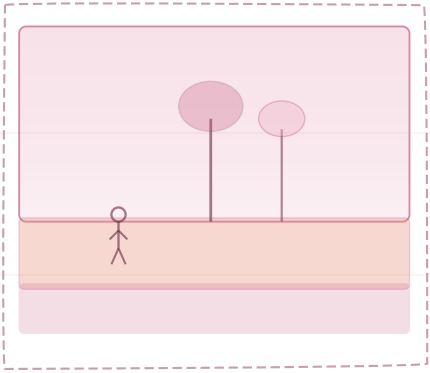
Not imagined —
but produced in reality.

Color is not a surface.
It is a result of processes.

If color can be produced,
can it be designed?

Landscape is no longer an object.
It becomes a system that produces color.

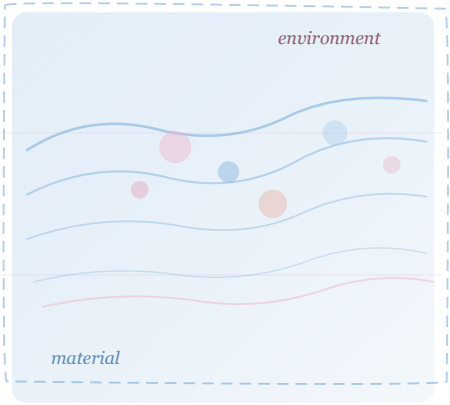
object



→

feedback

system



time

surface color ____

color emerges _____

[static representation]

[dynamic, relational field]

thesis sketch — color as produced condition

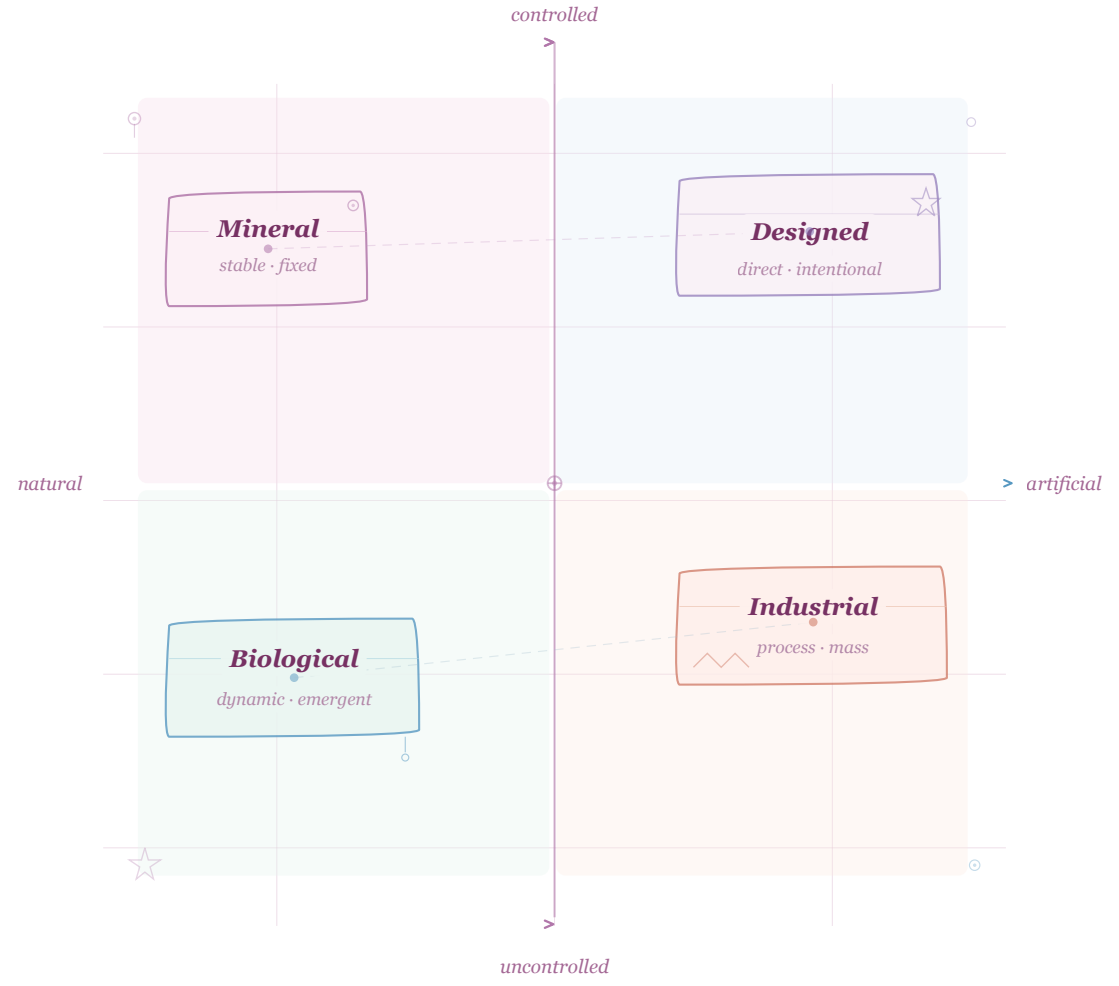
A method to understand
how color is produced

Typology → Case → Condition

from observation to system

Color is not random.
It comes from different systems.

Biological
Mineral
Industrial
Designed



typology — color as produced condition

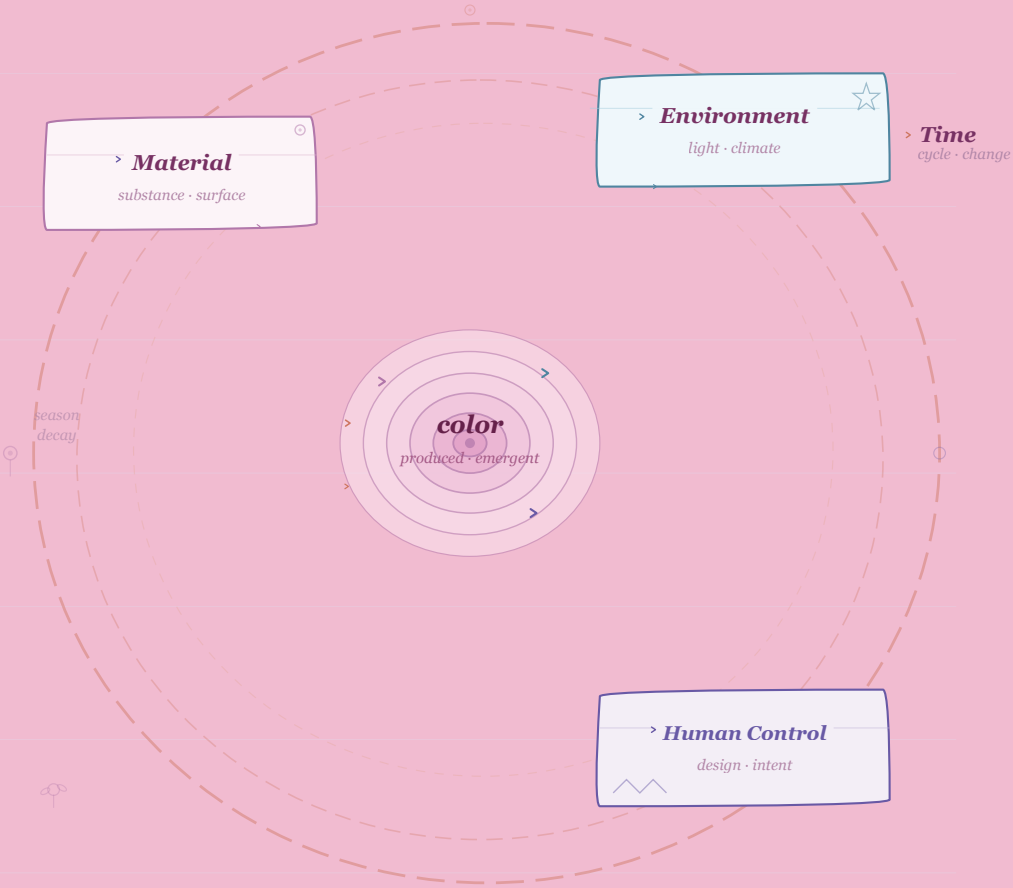
x: natural → artificial · y: uncontrolled → controlled

Cases show what color looks like.
Conditions explain how it happens.

From image → to mechanism

Color is produced by conditions:

Material
Environment
Time
Control



color = f (material × environment × time × human control)

system · dynamic · emergent

Color =
ƒ (material, environment, time, control)

Change the conditions,
and the color changes.

Different systems produce
different types of color.

They can be combined
into a hybrid landscape.

not one system, but many interacting

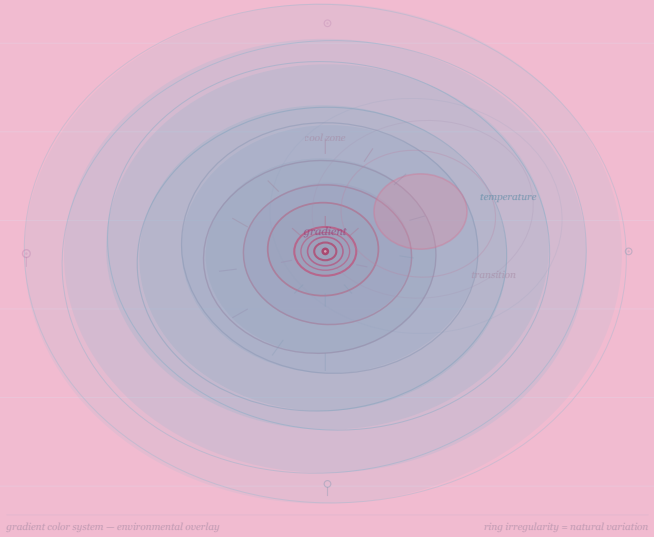
Color emerges from living systems

microbes · growth · metabolism

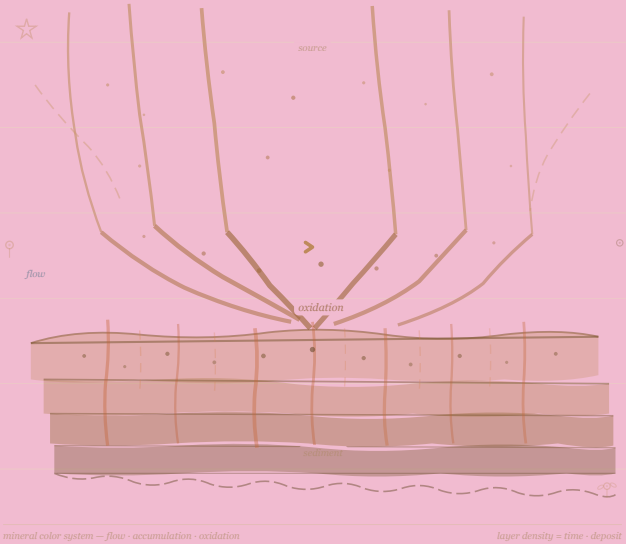
Lake Hillier, Western Australia

Color follows environmental gradients

temperature → color bands



Yellowstone, Wyoming, USA



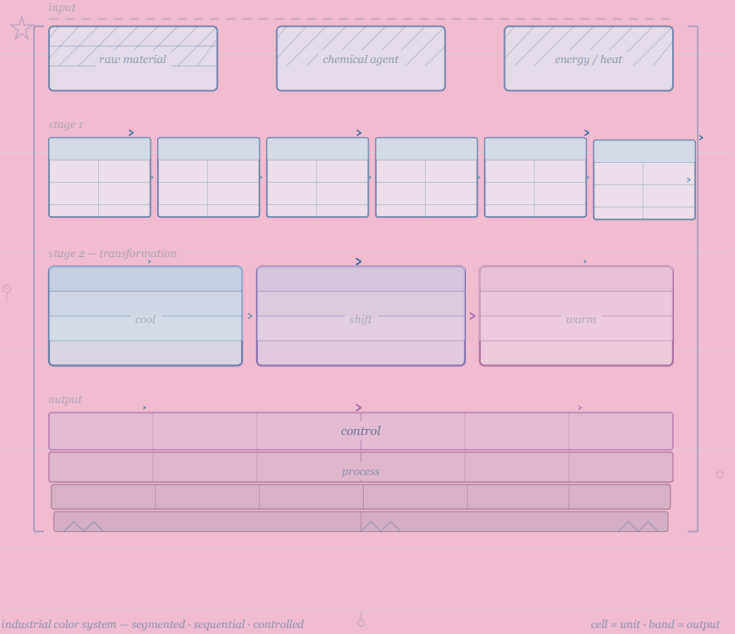
Color results from material transformation

oxidation · sediment

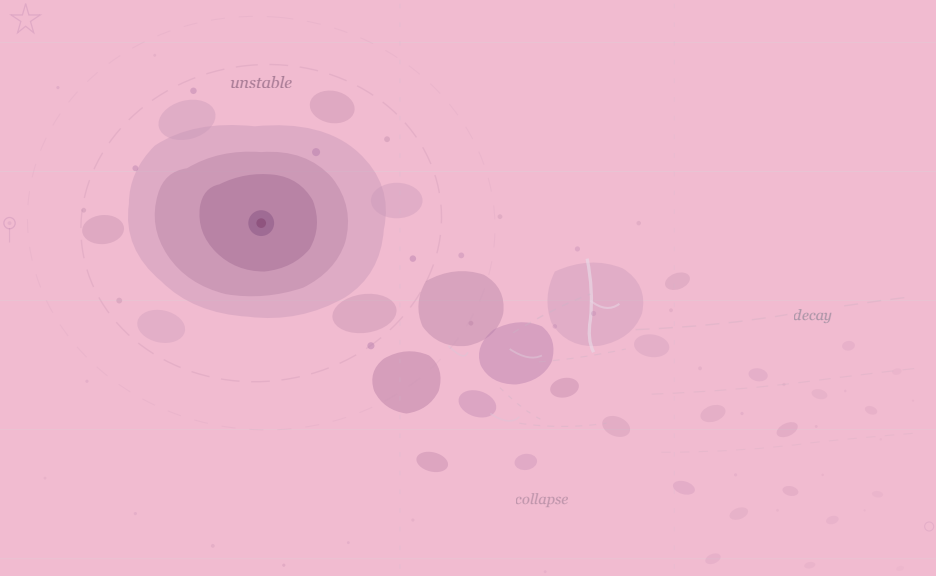
Rio Tinto, Andalusia, Spain

Color is produced through controlled processes

evaporation · concentration · sequence



Atacama Desert, Chile



Color can be unstable

bloom · collapse · risk

unstable color system — expansion · fragmentation · dissolution

opacity = stability · size = coherence

Salton Sea, California, USA

Different systems produce different behaviors

control vs stability

comparison — x: control · y: stability · dot size = intensity of behavior

typology diagram

Bio Logic

Color emerges from living systems

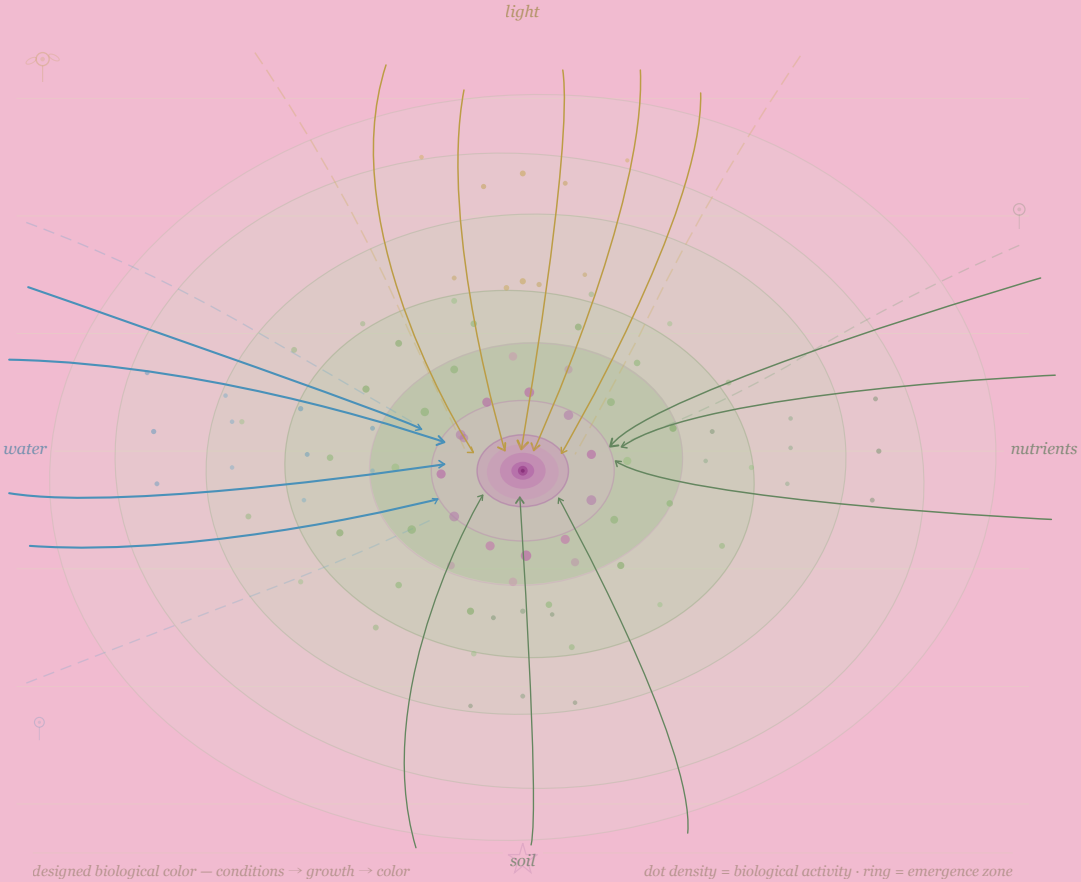
Biological color is produced by organisms responding to environmental conditions over time

Bio Strategy

Design does not apply color
It sets the conditions for growth

HOW TO DESIGN:

adjust light exposure to trigger pigment production
control water and salinity to support microbial growth
introduce nutrients to activate biological processes



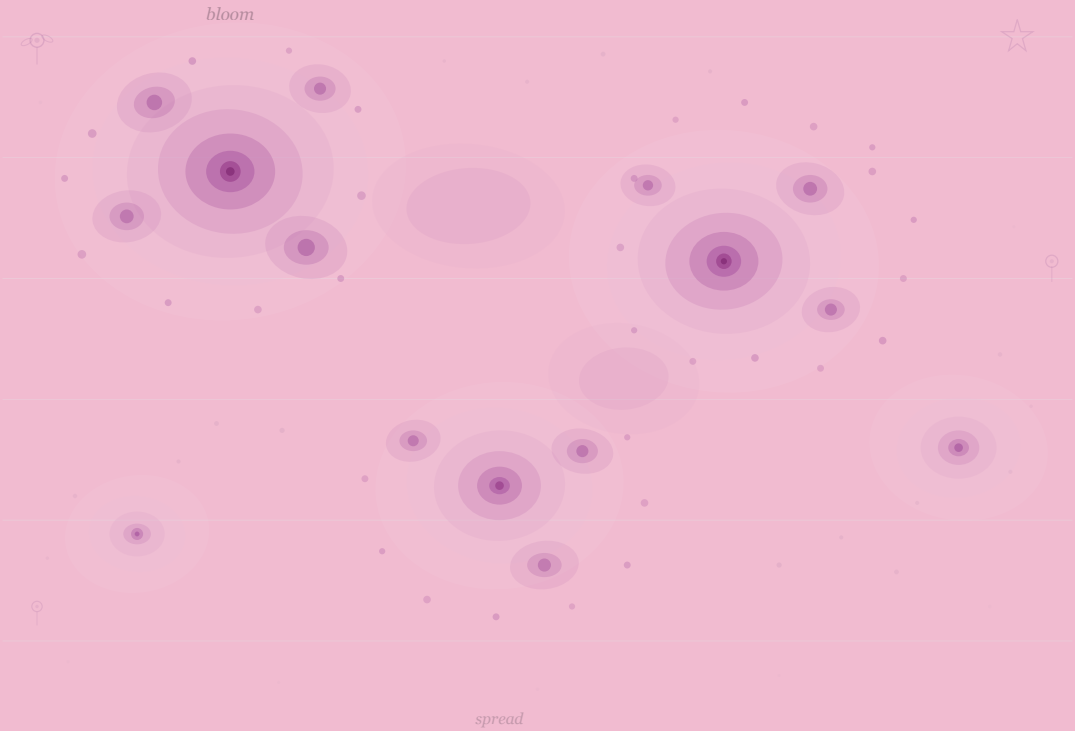
Bio Spatial Form

Color appears as spatial patterns

HOW IT FORMS:

clusters emerge and expand unevenly
gradients form through density variation
boundaries remain soft and unstable

SPATIAL EFFECT:
patch · bloom · spread



Mineral Logic

Color results from material transformation

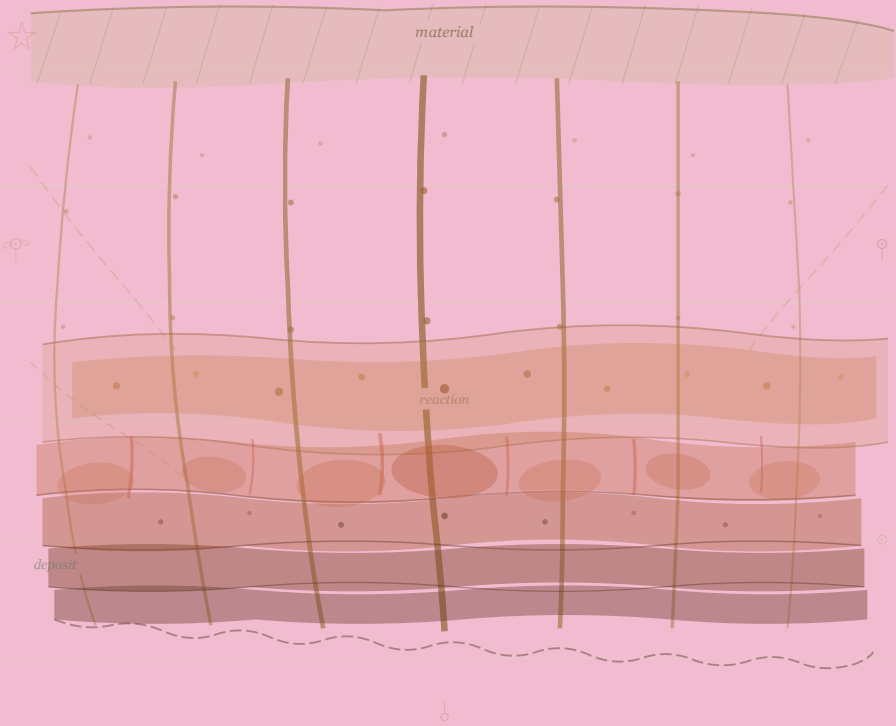
Mineral color is produced through chemical reactions such as oxidation and sedimentation

Mineral Strategy

Design manipulates material composition

HOW TO DESIGN:

expose specific minerals to air and water
guide flow to concentrate reactive materials
control chemical conditions (pH, moisture, oxidation)



mineral transformation — material · flow · reaction · color

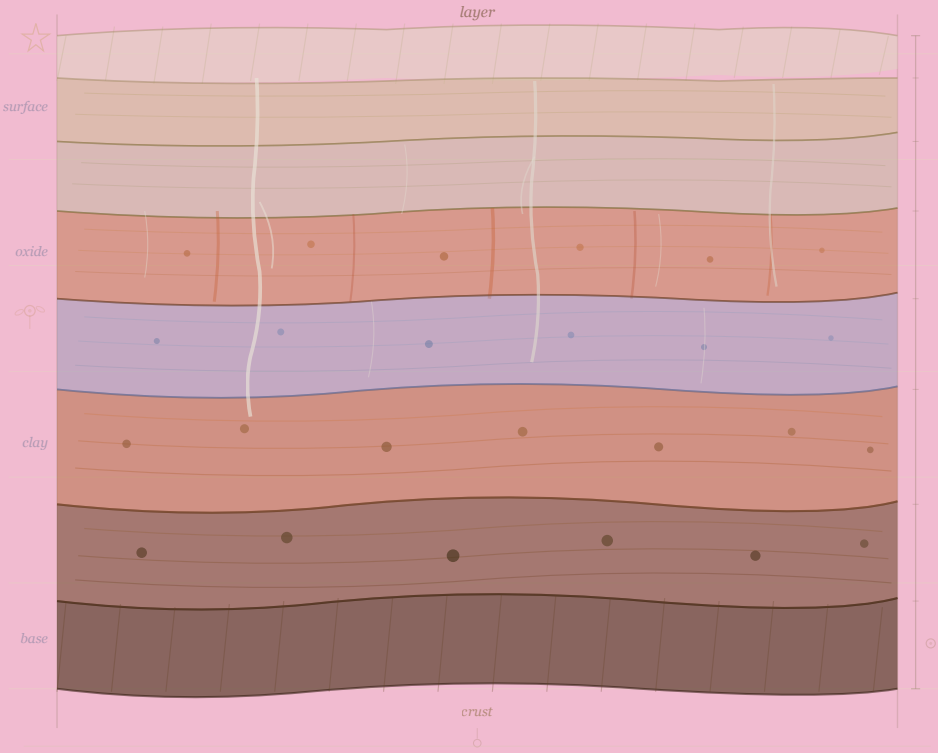
band depth = time · streak = oxidation path

Mineral Spatial Form

Color forms through accumulation

HOW IT FORMS:

layers build up over time
deposits concentrate along flows
surfaces harden into crusts



Industrial Logic

Color is produced through controlled processes

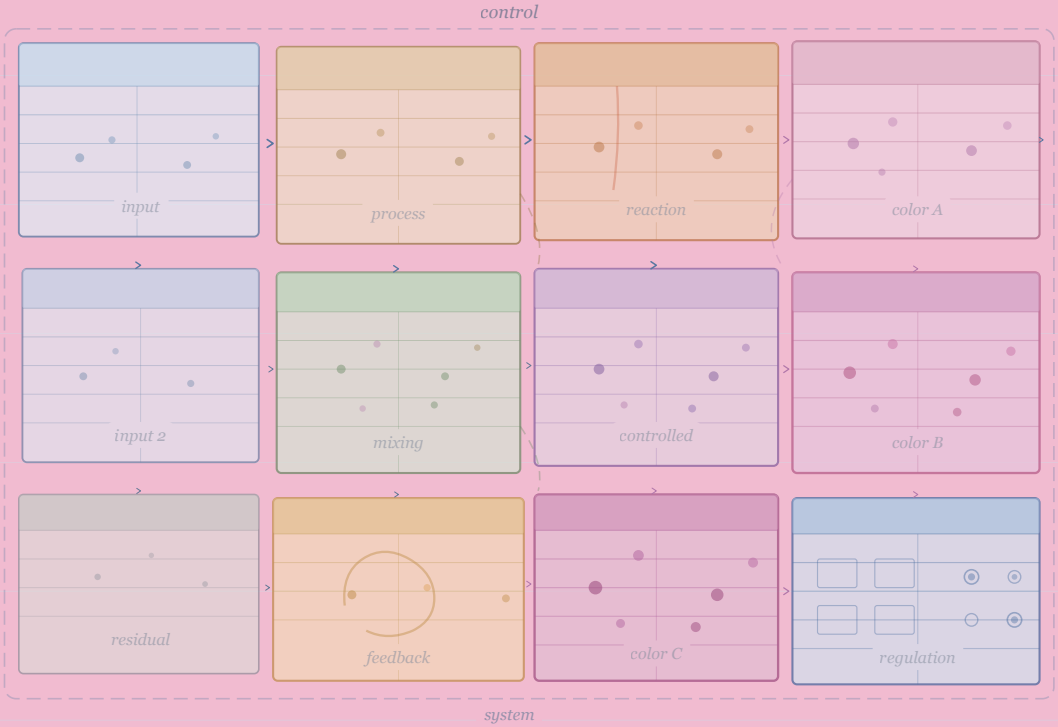
industrial systems organize
material transformation in sequence

Industrial Strategy

Design organizes color as a system

HOW TO DESIGN:

divide space into controlled units
regulate flow and timing
assign color to each stage



designed color system — segmented · connected · regulated

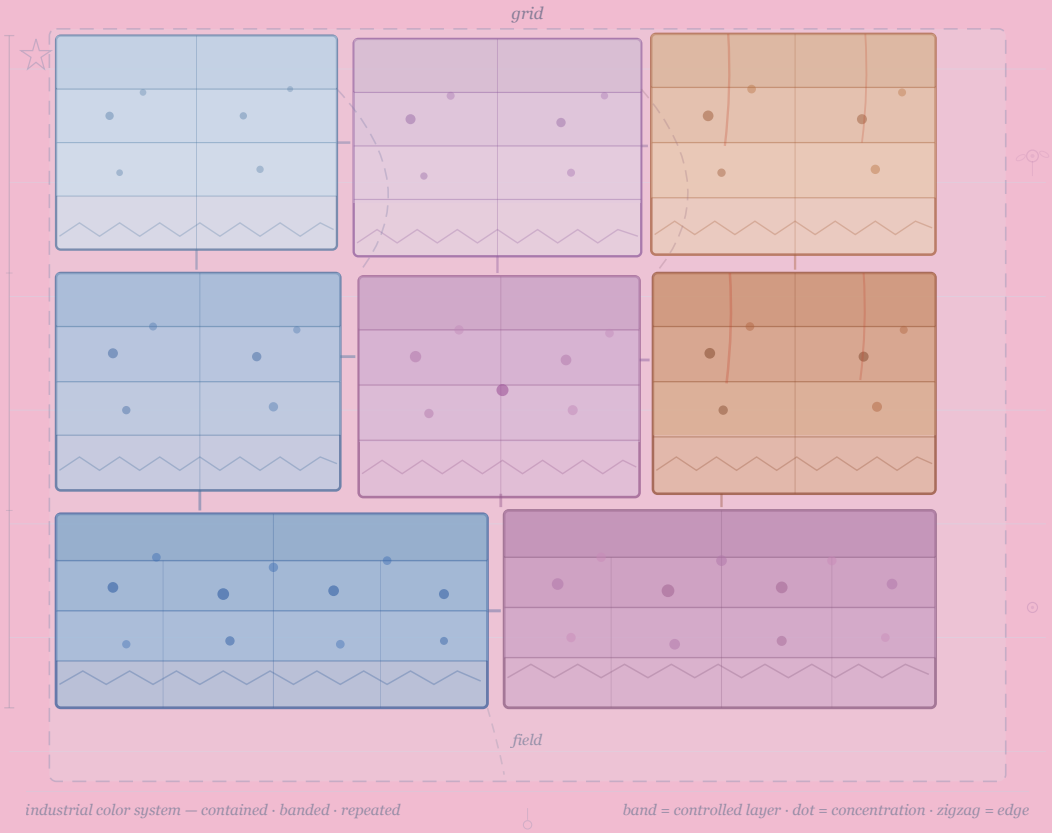
dot size = color intensity · arrow = controlled flow

Industrial Spatial Form

Color appears as organized fields

HOW IT FORMS:

repeated units create patterns
boundaries are clear
color is distributed in zones



industrial color system — contained · banded · repeated

band = controlled layer · dot = concentration · zigzag = edge

Designed Logic

Color is introduced through design decisions

designed color is produced through
materials, surfaces, and constructed elements

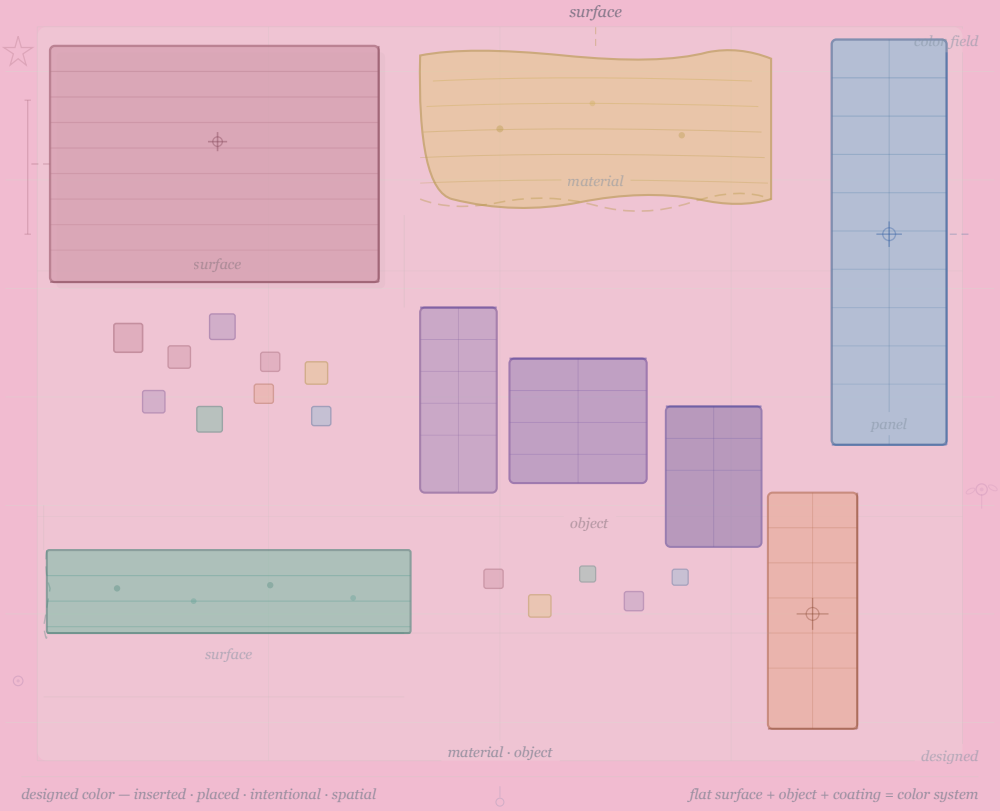
material
surface
assembly

Designed Strategy

Design places color directly in space

HOW TO DESIGN:

select materials with strong chromatic identity
organize color through surface, pattern, or object
use placement and contrast to construct experience



designed color — inserted · placed · intentional · spatial

flat surface + object + coating = color system

Final Statement

Landscape can be designed
through systems of color production

biological, mineral, industrial, and designed
operate as different but related ways
of bringing imagined color into reality